THE UNIVERSITY OF KANSAS

Math 290
Elementary Linear Algebra
Spring 2026 Syllabus

Contents

1 Instructor and Sections **2**

1.1 Instructor Contact Information and Office Hours . . . 2
1.2 Sections and Meeting Times . . . 2

2 Structure of Math 290 **2**

2.1 Course Description . . . 2
2.2 Credit Hours and Expectations . . . 2
2.3 Required Textbook & Materials . . . 2
2.4 Course Requirements . . . 3
2.5 Course Format and Teaching Methods . . . 3
2.6 Participation Policy . . . 3
2.7 Evaluation Criteria and Grading Scale . . . 3
2.8 Grade Disclaimers and Disputes . . . 4
2.9 Withdrawal Dates . . . 4
2.10 Subject to Change . . . 4
2.11 Assignments and Examinations: Schedule/Due Dates . . . 4
2.12 Statement on Generative Artificial Intelligence . . . 5

3 Additional Resources and Policy Information **5**

3.1 Academic Misconduct . . . 5
3.2 Academic Support . . . 5
3.3 Change of Grade . . . 5
3.4 Commercial Note Taking . . . 6
3.5 Commitment to Integrity and Ethical Conduct . . . 6
3.6 Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) . . . 6
3.7 Diversity and Inclusion . . . 6
3.8 Freedom of Expression . . . 6
3.9 Intellectual Property . . . 6
3.10 Mandatory Reporting . . . 7
3.11 Religious Observances . . . 7
3.12 Students' Rights and Responsibilities . . . 7
3.13 Weapons, Including Firearms . . . 7
3.14 Further Reading . . . 7

1 Instructor and Sections

1.1 Instructor Contact Information and Office Hours

Instructor:	Dr. Nick Packauskas
Email:	packauskas@ku.edu
Office:	631 Snow Hall
Office Hours:	Tuesday 11 AM - 12 PM, Wednesday 10 - 11 AM, Thursday 1:30 - 2:30 PM and other times by appointment

All office hours will be conducted in Snow 631 unless otherwise noted. Please email me to set appointments outside of the times listed above or ask questions about the course. I will respond to all emails in a timely fashion, but **it is not guaranteed that I will respond to emails sent after 5:00 PM (central time) on weekdays or on weekends until the next business day.** Note that, unlike courses in the calculus sequence, there is no help room for this course. Office hours are the main way to seek assistance with homework.

1.2 Sections and Meeting Times

Dr. Packauskas is teaching three in-person sections of MATH 290, which meet twice a week on Monday and Wednesday or Tuesday and Thursday. Students are expected to attend all scheduled class meetings, and only the section in which they are enrolled.

Course	Time	Section	Classroom
MATH 290	MW 9:00 - 10:50 AM	46996	MAL 1003
MATH 290	MW 12:00 - 12:50 PM	51507	MAL 1003
MATH 290	TuTh 12:30 - 1:20 PM	52835	ROB 156

2 Structure of Math 290

2.1 Course Description

Mathematics - Elementary Linear Algebra (2) Spring 2026
Systems of linear equations, matrices, vector spaces, linear transformations, and applications. Not open to those who have taken MATH 590.
Prerequisite: MATH 126 or MATH 146 with grade of C- or higher.

2.2 Credit Hours and Expectations

This course is worth **2 credit hours**, and **regular class participation** is important for success. Even if you've taken a previous algebra course at the university level, this course will likely be taught from a more sophisticated perspective; if you expect this class to be review, you may be mistaken. You should expect to spend **at least two hours studying outside of class for every credit hour**; that means we expect you to spend 4-6 hours beyond attending lecture on course material each week, through homework, review, and use of resources. In contrast to most high school math classes, if you don't understand the topics being covered, you should NOT assume that your instructor will repeat material until you understand or master it. Whenever possible, you should ask questions during office hours and spend time thinking things through on your own. Don't wait! Mathematics is cumulative, so anything you don't understand now is likely to keep giving you trouble as the semester goes on. That said, mathematics does take time to learn and your assignments are staggered to generally give you at least a week to learn specific skills.

2.3 Required Textbook & Materials

E-Textbook: Linear Algebra with Applications, 2E, by Jeffrey Holt, ISBN: 978-1-4641-9334-7

Achieve: Achieve is the online homework platform and is accessed through Canvas.

iClicker: iClicker is used in lecture to take attendance and collect your answers to questions.

- You will have access to the E-textbook, and Achieve through the "Auto Access" program; you will find details on Canvas.

- Make sure to **use your KU email** in Achieve.
- Visit https://www.iclicker.com/students/apps-and-remotes/apps to download the iClicker app to a smartphone or other device. (**Note that you must be physically present in lecture to earn iClicker points**)

Calculators: **Only basic or scientific calculators** will be permitted while taking exams. Calculators must not be able to perform matrix calculations (RREF, determinants, etc.) and must have no graphing capabilities.

2.4 Course Requirements

All assignments required for this course can be found with details on our course Canvas page. There will be two midterms taken in-class and a cumulative final exam. Below are the **tentative** dates for the midterm exams (any changes to these dates will be reflected on Canvas). The final exam is scheduled according to the university final exam schedule.

Class time	Midterm 1 Date	Midterm 2 Date	Final Exam Date and Time
MW 9:00 - 9:50 AM	March 2	April 15	Thursday, May 14, 7:30 AM - 10:00 AM
MW 12:00 - 12:50 PM	March 2	April 15	Monday, May 11, 10:30 AM - 1:00 PM
TuTh 12:30 - 1:20 PM	March 3	April 16	Friday May 15, 10:30 AM - 1:00 PM

2.5 Course Format and Teaching Methods

This course in-person in a class lecture format. There will be two lectures each week. Students are expected to attend the lectures, answer iClicker questions, and complete homework assignments (both online through Achieve and handwritten) each week.

2.6 Participation Policy

Excused Absences Policy

The responsibility for attendance and class participation rests with individual students. Students are expected to keep up with course material and meet all requirements set by the instructor. Students are responsible for planning their schedules to avoid excessive conflicts with course requirements.

Whenever a student has an excused absence that prevents them from attending class or completing an assignment, the student should notify the instructor in advance of the absence whenever possible. Please be prepared to submit documentation whenever appropriate. We understand that it may not always be possible have documentation, so one week's attendance can be excused without documentation. After this, we will request documentation to be excused further.

Please see the University Excused Absences policy for legitimate reasons for an excused absence.

Students are responsible for informing their instructors of an absence before the absence occurs, including providing verifiable documentation with as much advance notice as possible, or if not possible prior to, as soon as possible after the absence. **In the case where a student does not want to disclose specific details of the verifiable absence to an instructor**, the student may use the Student Support and Case Management Office and/or the Student Access Center to assist in the verification of an excused absence. In these cases, the Student Support and Case Management Office and the Student Access Center will provide confirmation to the instructor verifying the excused absence without providing specific details of the reason.

Make up exams will only be given in extreme circumstances with proper documentation for university-approved reasons.

2.7 Evaluation Criteria and Grading Scale

The following is a breakdown for Math 290 showing the components of the course and how much each component is worth.

Final Exam	30%
Midterm 1	20%
Midterm 2	20%
Achieve Homework	13%
Written Homework	13%
iClicker (includes attendance)	4%

The following is a breakdown for Math 290 showing the grading scale for final grades.

A	B	C	D	F
$\geq 88\%$	$\geq 78\%$	$\geq 68\%$	$\geq 58\%$	$< 58\%$

Note that there are no plus/minus grades, and there will not be a curve. Students within 0.5% of a grade will only be rounded up if they have submitted all assignments on time and have no unexcused absences.

You may be assigned an 'I' (Incomplete) grade if you are unable to complete some portion of the assigned coursework because of an unanticipated illness, accident, work-related responsibility, family hardship, or verified learning disability. An Incomplete grade is not intended to give you additional time to complete course assignments or extra credit unless there is indication that the specified circumstances prevented you from completing course assignments on time.

You will have multiple opportunities to provide feedback on your experience in this course. Suggestions and constructive criticism are encouraged throughout the course and may be particularly valuable early in the semester. You will also be asked to complete an end-of-semester, online Student Survey of Teaching, which could inform modifications to this course (and/or related courses) in the future.

2.8 Grade Disclaimers and Disputes

Students should regularly visit the Canvas page to find their exam scores, assignment scores, course announcements, assignments, detailed course schedule, and links to course materials. Students must regularly check both **their KU email** and the **course Canvas page**.

You can view the feedback for graded items by clicking on the grades. The instructor of Math 290 will check the grading of any assignment if the assignment was graded within the past two weeks; after two weeks, the instructors are not obligated to check the grading of an assignment.

Even on the Canvas page, the **"Total" column of the Canvas grade book may at times be inaccurate** but you can contact your instructor (Dr. Packauskas, packauskas@ku.edu) at any time with questions or to set an appointment to discuss your standing in the course.

2.9 Withdrawal Dates

Day	Date	Type
Monday	February 9th	Last day to withdraw/drop without a "W"
Monday	April 20th	Last day to withdraw from a class or the University

2.10 Subject to Change

The Tentative Course Schedule and/or Syllabus may be subject to changes by the instructor, as necessary. Should any changes become necessary, these will be communicated on the course's Canvas Main page.

2.11 Assignments and Examinations: Schedule/Due Dates

Please see the Tentative Course Schedule document for more details on due dates and topics.

Written Homework	Written homework will be posted to Canvas weekly, and will typically be due on Thursdays at 11:59 PM with some exceptions (see Canvas or the scheduled for details). Written homework is expected to be handwritten cleanly, showing all work and writing in complete sentences where appropriate. While students are encouraged to work together on homework, they should write their solutions individually. Students must upload their completed homework as a PDF to Canvas by 11:59 pm on Thursday each week. If having trouble uploading, students **MUST** email the worksheet to their instructor **before** the deadline. One written homework will be dropped at the end of the semester. Late homework and physical copies of homework will not be accepted. **Note that this includes submission errors – it is the student's responsibility to ensure the correct file is uploaded on time**. Students are expected to work with the instructor regarding extended excused absences. Up to one homework can be excused in advance without documentation.
Achieve Homework	Links will be on the week's Canvas module, and will typically be due each Tuesday at 11:59 PM. Achieve gives you instant feedback on your work. You have 4 attempts for each question and a 5% penalty for incorrect attempts before entering the correct answer. **Late policy**: Late Achieve assignments will not be accepted. However, all achieve assignments will reopen on Monday, 5/4 for Final Exam studying and students may complete questions with remaining attempts at this time. All reopened assignments will close for the final time on Sunday, 5/10 at 11:59 PM.
Exams	Midterms will take place during your scheduled class. Finals will be scheduled according to the university final exam schedule. Resources for studying will be made available.

2.12 Statement on Generative Artificial Intelligence

This purpose of this class is to develop your problem solving and technical writing skills using basic principles of arithmetic and linear algebra. In no part of this class should you be using generative AI to create, edit, or evaluate your work. None of your submitted work should be generated by an AI agent, and none of the intellectual property of the instructor (i.e., assignments, notes, etc.) should be submitted to third-party generative AI models or websites. Use of generative AI will be considered academic misconduct in this course, in the same way that using an unapproved calculator or submitting plagiarized work would be considered improper.

3 Additional Resources and Policy Information

3.1 Academic Misconduct

You are required to abide by all KU policies on academic integrity. Cheating, plagiarism, or other academic misconduct may result in a failing grade on the assignment in question, notification of the student's dean, and usually further disciplinary sanctions, possibly including a failing grade in the course. You are encouraged to collaborate with other students on the homework assignments. However, each student must write up his or her own solutions and acknowledge all collaborators. Copying someone else's homework, or allowing someone else to copy yours, is considered to be a form of cheating. For more information, see KU's official policies on academic misconduct.

3.2 Academic Support

The Student Access Center (SAC) coordinates accommodations and services for all eligible students with disabilities. If you have a disability and wish to request accommodations, you should contact the SAC as soon as possible (22 Strong Hall; 785-864-4064; Link to SAC website). We also recommend that you contact the course coordinator (Dr. Packauskas, packauskas@ku.edu) and your graduate teaching assistant privately in regard to your needs in this course, as soon as possible.

3.3 Change of Grade

Grades cannot be changed after they have been submitted to the University Registrar except in certain cases specified by University Senate Rules and Regulations. See the Change of Grade Policy for more details.

3.4 Commercial Note Taking

Pursuant to the University of Kansas' Policy on Commercial Note-Taking Ventures, commercial note-taking is not permitted in Math 290. Lecture notes and course materials may be taken for personal use or for the purpose of mastering the course material, and may not be sold to any person or entity in any form. Any student engaged in or contributing to the commercial exchange of notes or course materials will be subject to discipline, including academic misconduct charges, in accordance with University policy. **Please note:** Note-taking provided by a student volunteer for a student with a disability, as a reasonable accommodation provided by the SAC, is not the same as commercial note-taking and is not covered under this policy.

3.5 Commitment to Integrity and Ethical Conduct

All members of our university community are expected to fulfill ethical and other professional standards at all times. Please see the Commitment to Integrity and Ethical Conduct Policy for more details.

3.6 Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS)

Personal Counseling Services can help students with issues related to adjusting to college and other psychological, interpersonal, and family problems. Individual sessions, group sessions and psychiatric services are available at the CAPS website.

If you or someone you know is in crisis or has urgent needs, help is available 24/7. During CAPS business hours, drop-in appointments are available by coming into CAPS and letting the front desk know that you need an urgent appointment. After business hours, you can call or text 988 (the Suicide and Crisis lifeline) or access any of the resources located at CAPS Crisis Support.

3.7 Diversity and Inclusion

All students are welcome in this course, regardless of age, ability, background, belief, ethnicity, gender, gender expression, gender identity, religious affiliation, sexual orientation, socioeconomic status, or any other variety of life experience.

- Diversity and Inclusion Policy
- Nondiscrimination Policy
- Racial and Ethinic Harassment Policy
- Sexual Harassment Policy

Instructors and students are both expected to contribute positively to an environment that respects the identities of others and welcomes diverse life experiences. If you are experiencing discrimination and/or harassment, please reach out to any of your specific instructors or to the course coordinator (Dr. Packauskas, packauskas@ku.edu). If your instructor or coordinator is causing you harm and you do not feel comfortable approaching the individual, there are additional resources on campus to support you, including:

- Center for Sexuality and Gender Diversity
- Office of Civil Rights and Title IX
- Office of Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Belonging
- Student Access Center

3.8 Freedom of Expression

The University of Kansas is committed to freedom of speech and expression as part of our goal to encourage the robust exchange of ideas and perspectives by students, employees and guests across our campuses. More on what this means is available at the Public Affairs Website.

3.9 Intellectual Property

Course materials prepared by the instructor, together with the content of all lectures and review sessions presented by the instructor are the property of the instructor. Video and audio recording of lectures and review sessions without the consent of the instructor is prohibited. Permission to make such recordings may be granted by the instructor on a case-by-case basis, on the condition that the individual making the recording uses these recordings only as a study aid. Unless explicit permission is obtained from the instructor, recordings of lectures and review sessions and course content may not be modified and must not be transferred or transmitted to any other person, whether or not that individual is enrolled in the course.

3.10 Mandatory Reporting

If a student shares information about discrimination or sexual harassment, including sexual violence, with a faculty or staff member (including professors and GTAs), the faculty or staff member **must** report the information to the Office of Civil Rights & Title IX. See the Mandatory Reporting Policy for details, including a list of those faculty and staff designated to provide confidential assistance.

3.11 Religious Observances

Any student in this course who plans to observe a religious holiday which conflicts in any way with the course schedule or requirements should complete the relevant forms through the Office of Diversity, Equity, Inclusion & Belonging and contact the course coordinator (Dr. Packauskas, packauskas@ku.edu) **before the end of the third week of classes** to discuss alternative accommodations.

3.12 Students' Rights and Responsibilities

Please see the Student Code for the rights of students and standards of conduct in the University of Kansas community.

3.13 Weapons, Including Firearms

Individuals who choose to carry concealed handguns are solely responsible to do so in a safe and secure manner in strict conformity with state and federal laws and KU weapons policy. Safety measures outlined in the KU weapons policy specify that a concealed handgun:

- Must be under the constant control of the carrier.
- Must be out of view, concealed either on the body of the carrier, or backpack, purse, or bag that remains under the carrier's custody and control.
- Must be in a holster that covers the trigger area and secures any external hammer in an un-cocked position
- Must have the safety on, and have no round in the chamber.

3.14 Further Reading

A list with links to Student Resources and KU Course Policies can be found here.